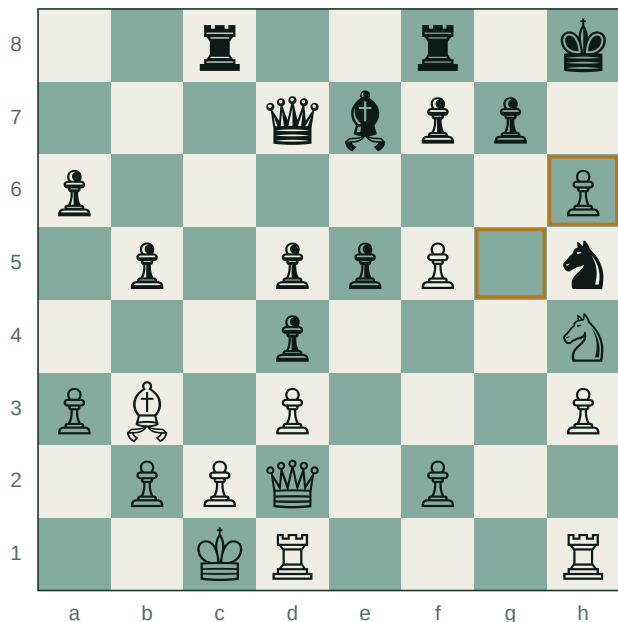


Active defensive resources: Black, move 20

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 20.gxh6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20...Bxh4 21. hxg7+ Kxg7 22. Rdg1+ Kh7

20...Bxh4 The bishop captures the knight on h4. Recorded reply: **21.hxg7+**.

21...Kxg7 The king captures the pawn on g7. Recorded reply: **22.Rdg1+**.

22...Kh7 The king moves from g7 to h7.

At the end, nominal material is White 29 / Black 31 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on c1. Absolute pin: pawn on c2.